

CRITERIA CATALOG FOR MEASURING DIGITAL SOVEREIGNTY
OF IT SERVICES AND CLOUD INFRASTRUCTURES

ES³ Sovereignty Maturity Level (SML) Framework

Imprint

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INTRODUCTION

1 Introduction

1.1 Digital Sovereignty

Digital sovereignty enables organizations to walk away from the negotiating table at any time. This fundamental capability guarantees customers the freedom to terminate or migrate the use of an IT service without unacceptable dependencies or risks. Securing this level of freedom demands a close look at three layers:

- **Technological Sovereignty:** Preventing vendor lock-in through open standards and flexible data portability.
- **Operational Sovereignty:** Maintaining business continuity and independent control over day-to-day operations.
- **Legal Sovereignty:** Providing full digital immunity and data protection against unauthorized or extraterritorial access.

1.2 SML Framework

The Sovereignty Maturity Level (SML) Framework is an auditable framework designed to assess the digital sovereignty of IT services across nine sovereignty dimensions, including Artificial Intelligence (AI). In this context, digital sovereignty is only as strong as its weakest link. This means that the overall SML always corresponds to the lowest level across all nine dimensions.

The framework follows three guiding principles:

- **Auditability:** Assessments must be evidence-based, comprehensible, and reproducible.
- **SML classification:** SMLs are assigned based on defined mandatory Controls for each level.
- **Comparability:** Results should be comparable between services/providers and over time.

The SML Framework encompasses the structure of the assessment (Dimensions, Control Objectives, Controls, Questions, Evidence) as well as the basic logic of the evidence-based evaluation. The SML classification is based on the assignment of Controls to the Sovereignty Maturity Levels (Initial, Managed, Advanced, Future-Proof).

1.3 EU CSF as the Foundation for ES³

The ES³ standard aligns with the EU Cloud Sovereignty Framework and adapts its eight strategic sovereignty objectives. The ES³ SML Framework operationalizes and expands these to include a ninth dimension: “Artificial Intelligence (AI)”.

1.4 Structure

The components of the SML framework are arranged in a hierarchical sequence:

Dimension → Control Objective → Control → Question → Evidence

Dimension: A Dimension describes a thematic area of digital sovereignty. It forms the highest structural level of the framework and groups multiple Control Objectives. It consists of the Dimension ID, the Dimension, and the Dimension Objective. It covers a strategic thematic area, aligns with EU digital sovereignty objectives, and remains stable over a longer period of time.

Question: This is a binary audit question (“Yes,” “No,” or “N/A”) used to verify the implementation of a Control. It consists of the Question ID and Question. Each Question addresses exactly one requirement and is formulated in a way that is uniquely verifiable and derives a specific piece of evidence.

Evidence: Evidence is the proof used to substantiate an answer to a Question. It must be specific, verifiable, and directly assignable to the Control.

Control Objective: A Control Objective describes a goal within a dimension that must be achieved to ensure digital sovereignty. It consists of the Control Objective ID, Control Objective, Control Objective Description, and the Sovereignty Contribution. It describes a target state, is technology-neutral, and is implemented through multiple Controls.

Control: A Control is organized along three implementation levels to ensure a structured and comprehensive implementation of Control Objectives. It consists of the Control ID, Control Description, Control Level, Control Scope, and Service Type. A Control covers a concrete measure, and is implementable and auditable.

Each Control is assigned to exactly one implementation level (Contractual, Governance and Operations, or Technical).

Permissible Evidence types include:

- Contracts or legal agreements
- Policies and procedural documentation
- Technical configurations or system extracts
- Audit reports or certifications
- Architecture diagrams

The Evidence must enable an independent third party to fully comprehend the assessment.



SML FRAMEWORK CATALOG

SML Framework Catalog

Schema:

[Dimension ID] - [Dimension]

[Dimension Objective]

[CONTROL OBJECTIVE ID] [CONTROL OBJECTIVE]

[Control Objective Description]

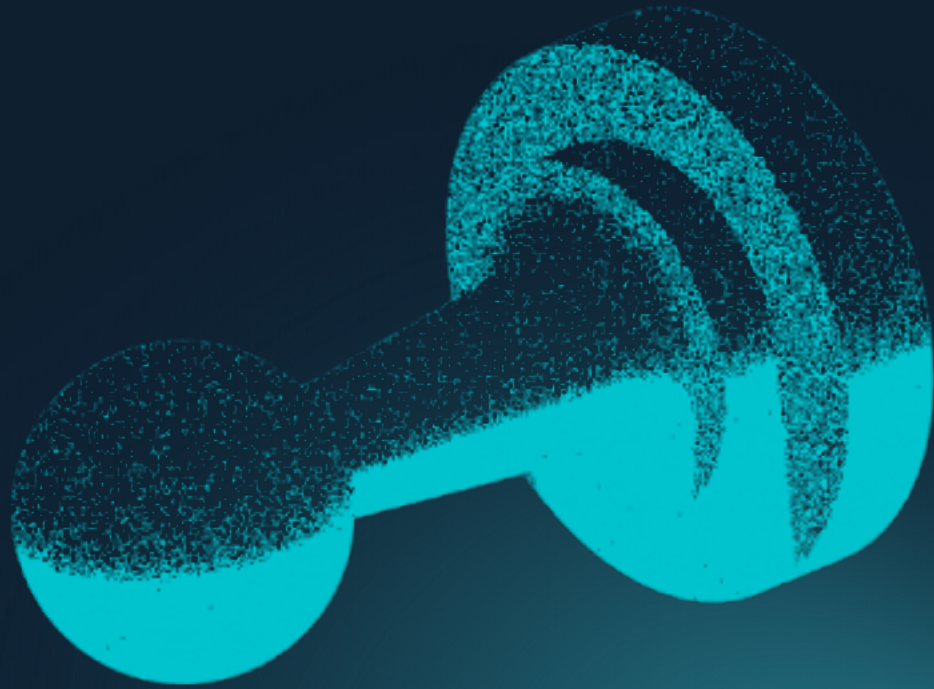
[Sovereignty Contribution]

[Control ID] [Control Level]

[Scope] | [Service Type]

[Control].

■ [Question ID]: [Question]



SML 1 STRATEGIC SOVEREIGNTY

SML 1 — Strategic Sovereignty

Strategic sovereignty evaluates the corporate governance architecture, ownership dependencies, and long-term continuity planning of the service provider.

SML 1.CO 1 GOVERNANCE AUTHORITY

Objective: To ensure that individuals and entities with significant governance and decision-making authority are clearly defined and formally designated in order to fulfill their responsibilities.

Sovereignty Contribution: Establishes strategic sovereignty by ensuring that control over service-related decisions is transparent, formally assigned, and free from undisclosed influence, enabling customers to understand who ultimately governs the service.

SML 1.CO 1.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

The entity exercising decisive control (and decision-making authority) over the service is clearly determined in terms of roles, bodies, and legal entities.

- **SML 1.CO 1.C 1.Q 1:** Is the entity exercising decisive control and decision-making authority over the service clearly determined?

SML 1.CO 1.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

The entity exercising decisive control (and decision-making authority) over the service has assigned all responsible entities and individuals to their services and tasks, and has made this information accessible to stakeholders.

- **SML 1.CO 1.C 2.Q 1:** Has the entity exercising decisive control and decision-making authority over the service formally assigned those responsible and informed affected entities, individuals and stakeholders about responsibilities for the services?

SML 1.CO 1.C 3 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Details of the nomination, assignment, services, and decision-making competencies regarding the related services are formally documented and accessible to all affected individuals and stakeholders.

- **SML 1.CO 1.C 3.Q 1:** Are the nomination, assignment, services, and decision-making competencies regarding the related services formally documented and accessible to all affected individuals and stakeholders?

SML 1.CO 2 OWNERSHIP AND CONTROL STRUCTURE

Objective: To ensure that ownership structures and controlling interests related to the service provider are transparent, identifiable, and do not introduce undisclosed external influence.

Sovereignty Contribution: Strengthens strategic sovereignty by ensuring that ownership and control structures are transparent and that controlling interests can be clearly attributed, reducing the risk of hidden or external influence over the service.

SML 1.CO 2.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

The ownership structure of the service provider is documented and transparent.

- **SML 1.CO 2.C 1.Q 1:** Is the ownership structure of the service provider documented and transparent?

SML 1.CO 2.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Ultimate beneficial ownership (UBO) of the service provider is identified and documented.

- **SML 1.CO 2.C 2.Q 1:** Is the ultimate beneficial ownership (UBO) of the service provider identified and documented?

SML 1.CO 3 STRATEGIC ALIGNMENT WITH DIGITAL SOVEREIGNTY OBJECTIVES

Objective: To ensure that digital sovereignty objectives are explicitly defined and embedded in the strategy and decision-making processes related to the service.

Sovereignty Contribution: Strengthens strategic sovereignty by ensuring that digital sovereignty is an intentional and managed objective, guiding decisions on architecture, providers, and dependencies rather than being incidental.

SML 1.CO 3.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Digital sovereignty objectives are defined, integrated, and updated in the entity's management policies to ensure digital sovereignty is considered in the implementation of the service or provider strategy at all levels.

- **SML 1.CO 3.C 1.Q 1:** How is it ensured that digital sovereignty objectives are defined, integrated, and updated in the entity's management policies and considered in the implementation of the service or provider strategy?

SML 1.CO 3.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Strategic decisions related to the service consider digital sovereignty objectives.

- **SML 1.CO 3.C 2.Q 1:** Are digital sovereignty objectives considered in strategic decisions related to the service?

SML 1.CO 4 STRATEGIC INDEPENDENCE AND EXIT CAPABILITY

Objective: To ensure that dependencies on the services are considered at the entity's strategic level and measures are in place to avoid disruptions in case of exits or substitution of the service.

Sovereignty Contribution: Strengthens digital sovereignty by ensuring that dependencies are considered and that implications are monitored and actively managed to maintain the service quality.

SML 1.CO 4.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

The level of dependency on external providers relevant to the offered services is regularly assessed and updated with regard to its impact on independence and exit capability.

- **SML 1.CO 4.C 1.Q 1:** How is the process designed to regularly define criteria and assess the level of dependency, while also considering the exit of contracted service providers where this affects the entity's own services?

SML 1.CO 4.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Measures are in place to continuously detect and monitor how the external service providers' relevant activities impact or disrupt the services offered by the entity.

- **SML 1.CO 4.C 2.Q 1:** Are measures in place to continuously detect and monitor the impact of external service providers?

SML 1.CO 4.C 3 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Measures for the substitution or exit of contracted external service providers are integrated into the decision-making process and design of processes that impact the provided services.

- **SML 1.CO 4.C 3.Q 1:** How is it ensured that the substitution or exit of contracted external service providers is considered in decision-making and the design of processes that impact the services provided by the entity?

SML 1.CO 5 ACCOUNTABILITY AND STRATEGIC OVERSIGHT

Objective: To ensure that accountability for digital sovereignty is clearly assigned and that oversight mechanisms are in place to monitor and enforce related objectives.

Sovereignty Contribution: Strengthens strategic sovereignty by ensuring that digital sovereignty is actively managed, with clear accountability and oversight, rather than remaining an abstract or unowned objective.

SML 1.CO 5.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Accountability for digital sovereignty is explicitly assigned to defined roles or management functions.

- **SML 1.CO 5.C 1.Q 1:** Is accountability for digital sovereignty explicitly assigned to defined roles or management functions?

SML 1.CO 5.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Mechanisms are in place to monitor and oversee digital sovereignty objectives at a strategic level.

- **SML 1.CO 5.C 2.Q 1:** Are mechanisms in place to monitor and oversee digital sovereignty objectives at a strategic level?



SML 2 LEGAL AND JURISDICTIONAL SOVEREIGNTY

SML 2 — Legal and Jurisdictional Sovereignty

Legal and jurisdictional sovereignty evaluates the legal frameworks, geographic processing boundaries, and regulatory environments governing the services.

SML 2.CO 1 JURISDICTIONAL ALIGNMENT OF GOVERNANCE AND CONTROL

Objective: To ensure that entities exercising governance, control, and decision-making authority over the service are subject to jurisdictions listed in the Approved Jurisdictions List (AJL).

Sovereignty Contribution: Establishes legal sovereignty by ensuring that decisive governance and control over the service are exercised within trusted jurisdictions, enabling enforceability and reducing exposure to conflicting legal frameworks.

SML 2.CO 1.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

The legal entity exercising decisive governance, control, or decision-making authority over the service is incorporated in a jurisdiction listed in the AJL.

- **SML 2.CO 1.C 1.Q 1:** Is the legal entity exercising decisive governance, control or decision-making authority over the service incorporated in a jurisdiction listed in the AJL?

SML 2.CO 1.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

All relevant entities that exercise governance, control, or decision-making authority over the service are clearly defined and incorporated in a jurisdiction listed in the AJL.

- **SML 2.CO 1.C 2.Q 1:** Are all relevant entities that exercise governance, control, or decision-making authority over the service clearly defined and incorporated in a jurisdiction listed in the AJL?

SML 2.CO 1.C 3 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Jurisdictional alignment of governance and control entities is regularly reviewed and documented.

- **SML 2.CO 1.C 3.Q 1:** Is the jurisdictional alignment of governance and control entities regularly reviewed and documented?

SML 2.CO 2 JURISDICTION OF SERVICE DELIVERY AND DATA PROCESSING

Objective: To ensure that service delivery, data processing, and operational execution occur within jurisdictions listed in the Approved Jurisdictions List (AJL).

Sovereignty Contribution: Strengthens legal sovereignty by ensuring that service delivery and data processing are performed within trusted jurisdictions, reducing exposure to conflicting legal frameworks.

SML 2.CO 2.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Contractual agreements ensure that data processing by the service provider is restricted to jurisdictions listed in the AJL.

- **SML 2.CO 2.C 1.Q 1:** Do contractual agreements ensure that data processing by the service provider is restricted to jurisdictions listed in the AJL?

SML 2.CO 2.C 2 Contractual

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: All

Contractual agreements ensure that data processing by underlying service providers is restricted to jurisdictions listed in the AJL.

- **SML 2.CO 2.C 2.Q 1:** Do contractual agreements ensure that data processing by underlying service providers is restricted to jurisdictions listed in the AJL?

SML 2.CO 2.C 3 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Service delivery and operational execution by the service provider are performed within jurisdictions listed in the AJL.

- **SML 2.CO 2.C 3.Q 1:** Are service delivery and operational execution by the service provider performed within jurisdictions listed in the AJL?

SML 2.CO 2.C 4 Governance and Operations

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: All

Service delivery and operational execution by underlying service providers are performed within jurisdictions listed in the AJL.

- **SML 2.CO 2.C 4.Q 1:** Are service delivery and operational execution by underlying service providers performed within jurisdictions listed in the AJL?

SML 2.CO 2.C 5 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Any service delivery or data processing outside jurisdictions listed in the AJL is identified, assessed, and formally approved.

- **SML 2.CO 2.C 5.Q 1:** Is any service delivery or data processing outside jurisdictions listed in the AJL identified, assessed, and formally approved?

SML 2.CO 3 CONTRACTUAL TRANSPARENCY AND LEGAL FRAMEWORK

Objective: To ensure that contractual agreements clearly define applicable law, jurisdiction, and key rights and obligations related to the service.

Sovereignty Contribution: Strengthens legal sovereignty by ensuring that contractual frameworks are transparent, enforceable, and aligned with trusted jurisdictions.

SML 2.CO 3.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: All

Contracts clearly define the applicable law governing the service.

- **SML 2.CO 3.C 1.Q 1:** Do contracts clearly define the applicable law governing the service?

SML 2.CO 3.C 2 Contractual

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: All

Contracts clearly define the jurisdiction and competent courts for dispute resolution.

- **SML 2.CO 3.C 2.Q 1:** Do contracts clearly define the jurisdiction and competent courts for dispute resolution?

SML 2.CO 3.C 3 Contractual

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: All

Contracts clearly define key rights and obligations related to the service, including responsibilities of all involved parties.

- **SML 2.CO 3.C 3.Q 1:** Do contracts clearly define key rights and obligations related to the service?

SML 2.CO 4 LEGAL ENFORCEABILITY AND PROTECTION OF RIGHTS

Objective: To ensure that rights and obligations related to the service are enforceable and protected within jurisdictions listed in the AJL, including protection against conflicting or extraterritorial legal access.

Sovereignty Contribution: Strengthens legal sovereignty by ensuring that contractual rights can be effectively enforced and that exposure to conflicting legal regimes is minimized.

SML 2.CO 4.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: All

Contracts ensure that rights and obligations related to the service are enforceable within jurisdictions listed in the AJL.

- **SML 2.CO 4.C 1.Q 1:** Do contracts ensure that rights and obligations related to the service are legally enforceable within jurisdictions listed in the AJL?

SML 2.CO 4.C 2 Contractual

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: All

Contracts address and restrict exposure to extraterritorial legal access or conflicting legal obligations.

- **SML 2.CO 4.C 2.Q 1:** Do contracts address and restrict exposure to extraterritorial legal access or conflicting legal obligations?

SML 2.CO 4.C 3 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Legal risks related to enforceability and conflicting jurisdictions are identified, assessed, and managed.

- **SML 2.CO 4.C 3.Q 1:** Are legal risks related to enforceability and conflicting jurisdictions identified, assessed, and managed?

SML 2.CO 4.C 4 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Mechanisms and processes are in place to handle legal requests or claims from non-AJL jurisdictions.

- **SML 2.CO 4.C 4.Q 1:** Are mechanisms and processes in place to handle legal requests or claims from non-AJL jurisdictions?

SML 2.CO 4.C 5 Technical

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Technical measures are implemented to support protection against unauthorized or extraterritorial access to the service.

- **SML 2.CO 4.C 5.Q 1:** Are technical measures implemented to support protection against unauthorized or extraterritorial access to the service?

SML 2.CO 5 EXPOSURE TO NON-AJL JURISDICTIONS

Objective: To ensure that exposure to jurisdictions not listed in the AJL is identified, assessed, and appropriately managed.

Sovereignty Contribution: Strengthens legal sovereignty by providing transparency regarding third-country exposure and ensuring that associated risks are actively managed and mitigated.

SML 2.CO 5.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: All

Contracts transparently disclose any involvement in the provision of the service by jurisdictions not listed in the AJL.

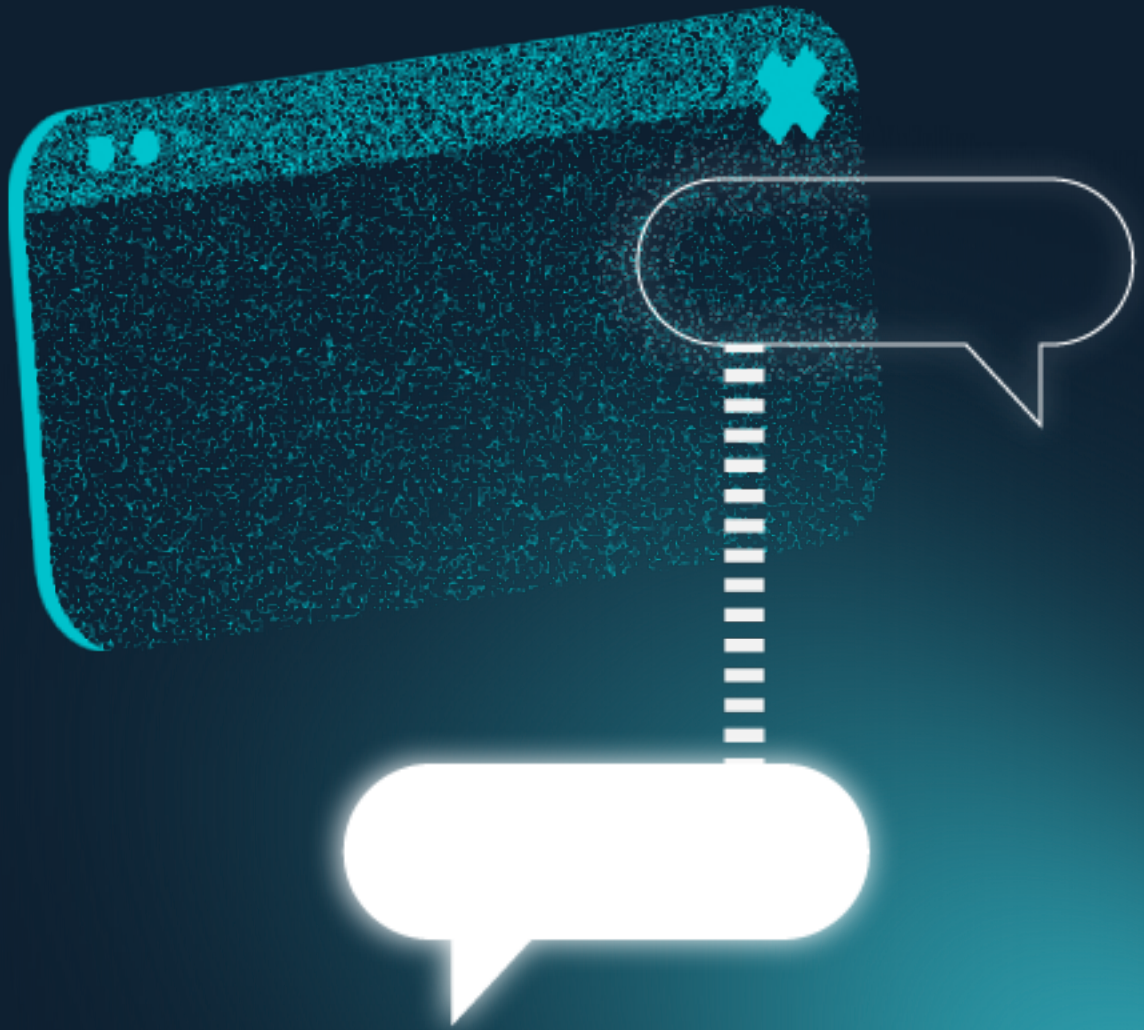
- **SML 2.CO 5.C 1.Q 1:** Do contracts transparently disclose any involvement in the provision of the service by jurisdictions not listed in the AJL?

SML 2.CO 5.C 2 Contractual

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: All

Contracts define safeguards and conditions for the involvement of jurisdictions not listed in the AJL.

- **SML 2.CO 5.C 2.Q 1:** Do contracts define safeguards and conditions for the involvement of jurisdictions not listed in the AJL?



SML 3

DATA SOVEREIGNTY

SML 3 — Data Sovereignty

Data sovereignty measures the control parameters established over data assets throughout their life cycle.

SML 3.CO 1 ACCESS CONTROL

Objective: To ensure customers retain control over access to their data.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that customers can independently define and enforce access to their data without reliance on the provider. Prevents unauthorized and privileged provider access and enables full control through technical enforcement mechanisms, including customer-controlled cryptographic keys.

SML 3.CO 1.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Contracts ensure that the customer retains sole authority to define, grant, modify, and revoke access rights to their data.

- **SML 3.CO 1.C 1.Q 1:** Does the contract explicitly grant the customer sole authority to define, grant, modify, and revoke access to their data?

SML 3.CO 1.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Policies and procedures ensure that access to customer data is restricted to authorized entities and is not performed without explicit customer authorization.

- **SML 3.CO 1.C 2.Q 1:** Are policies and procedures in place to ensure that access to customer data is restricted and only performed with explicit customer authorization?

SML 3.CO 1.C 3 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: SaaS, Managed Service, AI Service

Customers use role-based and/or attribute-based access control models to define, assign, and enforce access rights to their data.

- **SML 3.CO 1.C 3.Q 1:** Can customers independently define and enforce access rights to their data using role-based or attribute-based access control mechanisms?

SML 3.CO 1.C 4 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: SaaS, AI Service, Managed Service

Access to customer data is technically protected through cryptographic mechanisms, making access impossible without use of the corresponding cryptographic keys.

- **SML 3.CO 1.C 4.Q 1:** Is access to customer data technically enforced through encryption mechanisms that prevent access without the corresponding cryptographic keys?

SML 3.CO 1.C 5 Technical

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: PaaS, SaaS, AI Service, Managed Service

Customers can independently obtain, manage, and control cryptographic keys.

- **SML 3.CO 1.C 5.Q 1:** Can customers independently manage, rotate, and control cryptographic keys associated with their data?

SML 3.CO 1.C 6 Technical

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: IaaS, PaaS

The underlying services support customer-controlled key management and access control capabilities required to enforce customer-defined access restrictions.

- **SML 3.CO 1.C 6.Q 1:** Do the underlying services support customer-controlled key management and access control capabilities required to enforce customer-defined access restrictions?

SML 3.CO 2 PORTABILITY

Objective: To enable customers to access, retrieve, and export their data in a usable and portable manner.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that customers can retrieve and transfer their data without dependency on the provider, enabling effective data portability and preventing vendor lock-in.

SML 3.CO 2.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

The contract ensures that the customer can access, retrieve, and export their data at any time without undue restrictions or delays.

- **SML 3.CO 2.C 1.Q 1:** Does the contract ensure that the customer can access, retrieve, and export their data at any time without undue restrictions or delays?

SML 3.CO 2.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Processes exist that allow customers to retrieve and export data, including all relevant datasets required for continued use.

SML 3.CO 2.C 3 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

The service provides mechanisms that allow customers to access and retrieve their data independently via user interfaces and/or APIs.

SML 3.CO 2.C 4 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

Backup systems and data duplication locations are restricted to jurisdictions listed in the AJL.

SML 3.CO 2.C 5 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

Complete and correct data export is ensured to enable effective reuse of the data.

SML 3.CO 2.C 6 Technical

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: PaaS, IaaS

The underlying services support data extraction and transfer capabilities required to enable customer-driven data portability.

- **SML 3.CO 2.C 2.Q 1:** Are there defined and implemented processes ensuring that customer data can be retrieved and exported in a complete and consistent manner?
- **SML 3.CO 2.C 3.Q 1:** Can customers retrieve and/or export their data via a defined process?
- **SML 3.CO 2.C 4.Q 1:** Are backup systems and data duplication locations restricted to jurisdictions listed in the AJL?
- **SML 3.CO 2.C 5.Q 1:** Can a complete and correct data export be ensured?
- **SML 3.CO 2.C 6.Q 1:** Do the underlying services support data extraction and transfer capabilities required to enable customer-driven data portability?

SML 3.CO 3 USAGE CONTROL

Objective: To ensure customer data is only processed and used for purposes explicitly defined and authorized by the customer.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that customer data is not used beyond customer-defined purposes, preventing unauthorized processing and maintaining full control over how data is utilized.

SML 3.CO 3.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

The contract ensures that customer data is only processed and used for purposes explicitly defined and authorized by the customer.

SML 3.CO 3.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

The provider implements and enforces policies and procedures ensuring that customer data is not accessed or processed for purposes beyond those authorized by the customer.

SML 3.CO 3.C 3 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

The service ensures that data processing activities are limited to configured and authorized purposes and cannot be executed outside of these defined constraints.

- **SML 3.CO 3.C 1.Q 1:** Does the contract explicitly restrict the processing and use of customer data to purposes defined and authorized by the customer?
- **SML 3.CO 3.C 2.Q 1:** Are there enforced policies and procedures ensuring that customer data is not processed or used beyond authorized purposes?
- **SML 3.CO 3.C 3.Q 1:** Does the service ensure that data processing activities are restricted to configured and authorized purposes?

SML 3.CO 4 INTEGRITY

Objective: To ensure that customer data is protected against unauthorized modification or deletion.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that customer data cannot be altered or deleted without authorization, preserving data integrity and preventing unauthorized or provider-driven modifications.

SML 3.CO 4.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

The contract ensures that customer data cannot be modified or deleted without authorization as defined by the customer.

- **SML 3.CO 4.C 1.Q 1:** Does the contract explicitly ensure that customer data cannot be modified or deleted without customer-defined authorization?

SML 3.CO 4.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Policies and procedures exist ensuring that all modifications and deletions of customer data are authorized, traceable, and controlled.

- **SML 3.CO 4.C 2.Q 1:** Are there enforced policies and procedures ensuring that all data modification and deletion activities are authorized, controlled, and traceable?

SML 3.CO 4.C 3 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: SaaS, AI Service, Managed Service

The service ensures that all data modification and deletion actions are logged and regularly reviewed.

- **SML 3.CO 4.C 3.Q 1:** Are all changes to and deletions of data logged and regularly monitored?

SML 3.CO 4.C 4 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: SaaS, AI Service, Managed Service

The service provides mechanisms to protect data integrity, including versioning, immutability, or recovery capabilities to prevent or mitigate unauthorized changes or deletions.

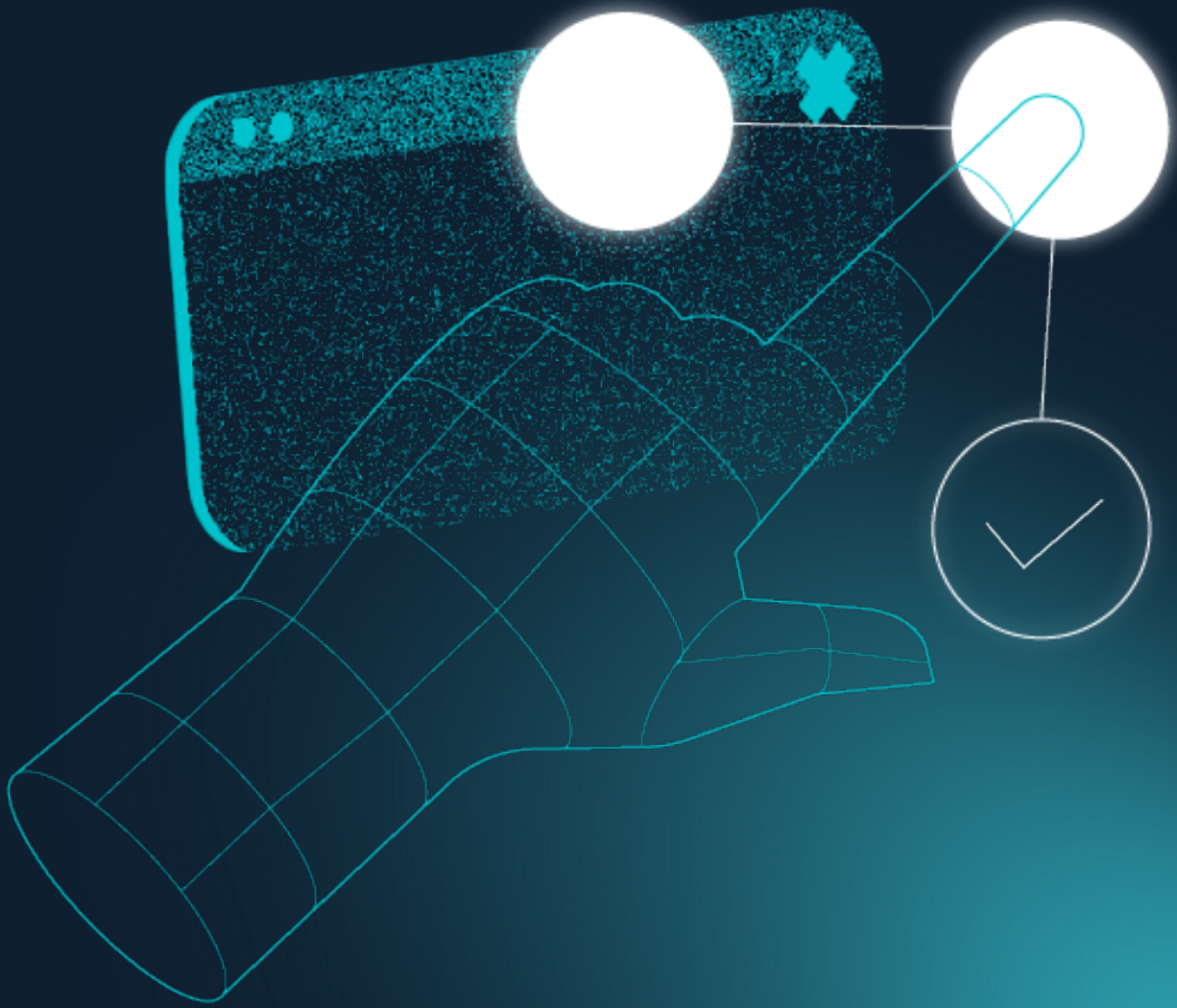
- **SML 3.CO 4.C 4.Q 1:** Does the service provide mechanisms such as versioning, immutability, or recovery capabilities to prevent or mitigate unauthorized data changes or deletions?

SML 3.CO 4.C 5 Technical

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: IaaS, PaaS

The underlying service supports mechanisms for ensuring data integrity and preventing unauthorized modification or deletion.

- **SML 3.CO 4.C 5.Q 1:** Does the underlying service support mechanisms to ensure data integrity and prevent unauthorized modification or deletion?



SML 4 OPERATIONAL SOVEREIGNTY

SML 4 — Operational Sovereignty

Operational sovereignty evaluates the capacity to run, maintain, and support services independently of external or unilateral provider controls.

SML 4.CO 1 OPERATIONAL CONTROL

Objective: To ensure that operational control over the service is defined, transparent, and not solely dependent on the provider.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that operational control of the service is not exclusively held by the provider, enabling customers to retain influence over service operation and reducing operational dependency.

SML 4.CO 1.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Contracts define operational roles and responsibilities, including allocation of control between the provider and customer.

- **SML 4.CO 1.C 1.Q 1:** Does the contract clearly define operational roles, responsibilities, and the allocation of control between the provider and customer?

SML 4.CO 1.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Documented operational governance structures are implemented and maintained to clearly define responsibilities and control over service operation.

- **SML 4.CO 1.C 2.Q 1:** Are there documented governance structures defining operational responsibilities and control over service operation?

SML 4.CO 1.C 3 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

The service provides customers with visibility and control over operational aspects relevant to their service usage.

- **SML 4.CO 1.C 3.Q 1:** Can customers monitor and influence operational aspects of the service relevant to their usage?

SML 4.CO 1.C 4 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

Critical operational actions cannot be executed solely by the provider without defined customer involvement or control, as applicable.

- **SML 4.CO 1.C 4.Q 1:** Are critical operational actions restricted such that they cannot be executed solely by the provider without defined customer involvement or control?

SML 4.CO 1.C 5 Technical

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: PaaS, IaaS

The underlying services support operational control capabilities that enable separation of responsibilities and reduce dependency on a single provider for service operation.

- **SML 4.CO 1.C 5.Q 1:** Do the underlying services support capabilities that enable separation of operational responsibilities and reduce dependency on a single provider?

SML 4.CO 2 ADMINISTRATIVE ACCESS

Objective: To ensure that administrative access to the service is controlled and not exclusively held by the provider.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that administrative control over the service is not exclusively held by the provider, enabling customers to manage or influence privileged access and reducing dependency on provider-controlled administration.

SML 4.CO 2.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Contracts define administrative roles, responsibilities, and privileged access, including allocation between the provider and customer.

- **SML 4.CO 2.C 1.Q 1:** Does the contract clearly define administrative roles, responsibilities, and the allocation of privileged access between the provider and customer?

SML 4.CO 2.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Policies and procedures are implemented and enforced to ensure administrative access is restricted, controlled, and assigned according to defined roles and responsibilities.

- **SML 4.CO 2.C 2.Q 1:** Are there enforced policies and procedures ensuring that administrative access is restricted and assigned based on defined roles and responsibilities?

SML 4.CO 2.C 3 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

The service enables customers to manage and control administrative access rights, where applicable.

- **SML 4.CO 2.C 3.Q 1:** Can customers manage and control administrative access rights, where applicable?

SML 4.CO 2.C 4 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

Critical administrative actions cannot be executed solely by the provider without customer involvement, approval, or separation of duties.

- **SML 4.CO 2.C 4.Q 1:** Are administrative actions restricted such that they cannot be executed solely by the provider without appropriate controls (e.g., customer approval or separation of duties)?

SML 4.CO 2.C 5 Technical

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: IaaS, PaaS
Underlying services provide role-based administrative access control and separation of privileged access.

- **SML 4.CO 2.C 5.Q 1:** Do the underlying services support role-based administrative access control and separation of privileged access?

SML 4.CO 3 SERVICE OPERATIONS

Objective: To ensure that service operations are defined, controlled, and do not create unmanaged dependency on the provider.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that day-to-day service operations are not solely controlled by the provider, enabling customers to retain influence over operational processes and reducing operational dependency.

SML 4.CO 3.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All
Contracts define the scope, responsibilities, and allocation of day-to-day service operations between the provider and customer.

- **SML 4.CO 3.C 1.Q 1:** Does the contract clearly define the scope, responsibilities, and allocation of day-to-day service operations between the provider and customer?

SML 4.CO 3.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All
Documented operational procedures are implemented and maintained to govern the execution of day-to-day service operations.

- **SML 4.CO 3.C 2.Q 1:** Are documented operational procedures in place governing the execution of day-to-day service operations?

SML 4.CO 3.C 3 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS
The service enables customers to monitor the operational status and execution of service operations relevant to their usage.

- **SML 4.CO 3.C 3.Q 1:** Can customers monitor the operational status and execution of service operations relevant to their usage?

SML 4.CO 3.C 4 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS
Operational activities are executed according to defined procedures and cannot be performed in an uncontrolled or discretionary manner by the provider.

- **SML 4.CO 3.C 4.Q 1:** Are service operations executed based on defined procedures without being subject to uncontrolled or discretionary execution by the provider?

SML 4.CO 4 INCIDENT AND RECOVERY

Objective: To ensure that incident response, recovery, and service continuity are defined, controlled, and not solely dependent on the provider.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that incident response and recovery are not exclusively controlled by the provider, enabling customers to retain influence over service restoration and continuity.

SML 4.CO 4.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All
Contracts define incident response, recovery, and service continuity responsibilities, including allocation of roles between the provider and customer.

- **SML 4.CO 4.C 1.Q 1:** Does the contract clearly define incident response, recovery, and service continuity responsibilities, including the allocation of roles between the provider and customer?

SML 4.CO 4.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Documented processes are implemented and maintained for incident response, recovery, and service continuity.

SML 4.CO 4.C 3 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

The service enables customers to monitor incidents and the status of recovery and continuity measures affecting their service usage.

SML 4.CO 4.C 4 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

Recovery and service restoration activities are executed according to defined procedures and do not rely solely on provider discretion.

SML 4.CO 4.C 5 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

The service enables customers to influence or initiate recovery and data restoration processes, where applicable.

SML 4.CO 4.C 6 Technical

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: IaaS, PaaS

Underlying services provide backup, recovery, and failover capabilities to enable independent and controlled restoration of services and data.

- **SML 4.CO 4.C 2.Q 1:** Are documented processes in place governing incident response, recovery, and service continuity?

- **SML 4.CO 4.C 3.Q 1:** Can customers monitor incidents and the status of recovery and continuity measures affecting their service usage?

- **SML 4.CO 4.C 4.Q 1:** Are recovery and service restoration activities executed based on defined procedures and not solely dependent on provider discretion?

- **SML 4.CO 4.C 5.Q 1:** Can customers influence or initiate recovery and data restoration processes, where applicable?

- **SML 4.CO 4.C 6.Q 1:** Do the underlying services provide backup, recovery, and failover capabilities that enable controlled and independent restoration of services and data?

SML 4.CO 5 CHANGE AND SERVICE EVOLUTION

Objective: To ensure that changes to the service are defined, controlled, and cannot be unilaterally executed by the provider.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that service changes are not exclusively controlled by the provider, enabling customers to retain influence over service evolution and preventing unilateral changes that impact service usage.

SML 4.CO 5.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Contracts define change management responsibilities, including the roles of the provider and customer in approving and implementing service changes.

SML 4.CO 5.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Documented change management processes are implemented and maintained to govern planning, approval, and implementation of service changes.

SML 4.CO 5.C 3 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

The service enables customers to be informed about and, where applicable, to approve or configure service changes affecting their usage.

SML 4.CO 5.C 4 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

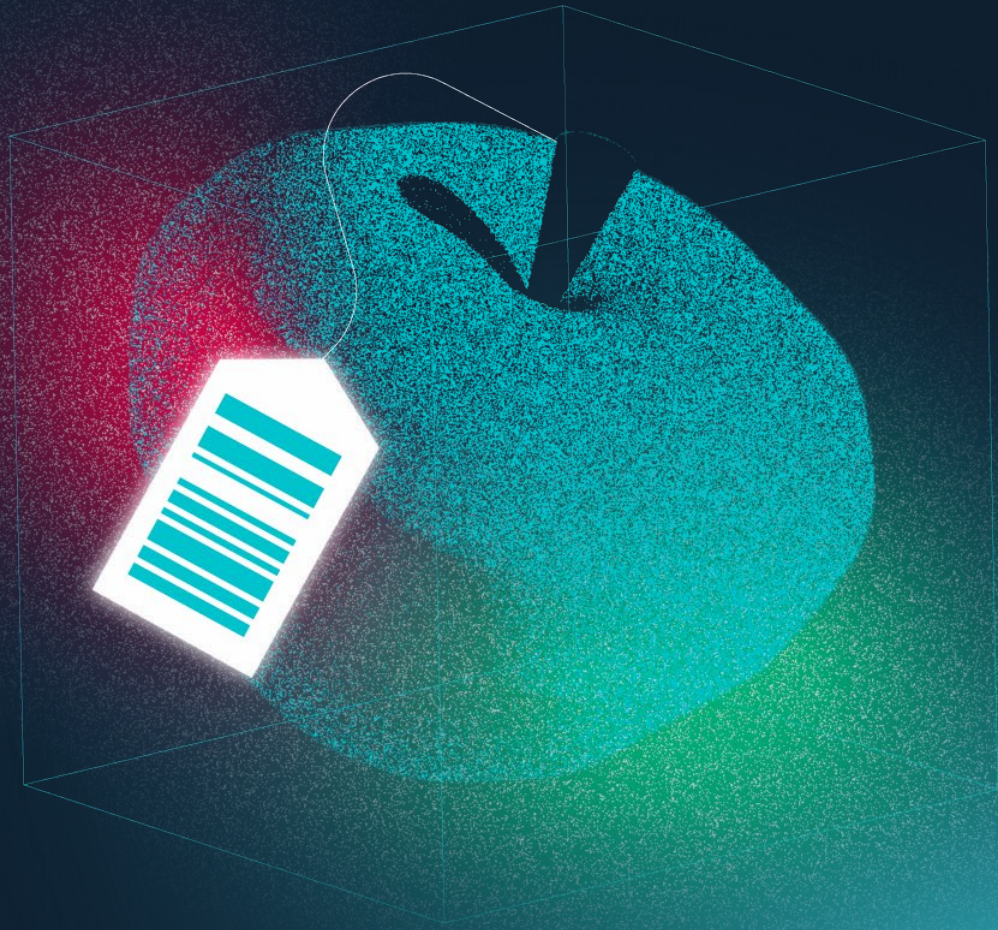
Changes affecting customer-relevant functionality or service behavior cannot be executed unilaterally by the provider without defined control mechanisms.

- **SML 4.CO 5.C 1.Q 1:** Does the contract clearly define change management responsibilities, including the roles of the provider and customer in approving and implementing service changes?

- **SML 4.CO 5.C 2.Q 1:** Are documented change management processes in place governing the planning, approval, and implementation of service changes?

- **SML 4.CO 5.C 3.Q 1:** Are customers informed about service changes and, where applicable, able to approve or configure changes that impact their usage?

- **SML 4.CO 5.C 4.Q 1:** Are changes affecting customer-relevant functionality or service behavior prevented from being executed unilaterally by the provider without defined control mechanisms?



SML 5 SUPPLY CHAIN SOVEREIGNTY

SML 5 — Supply Chain Sovereignty

Supply chain sovereignty measures the geographic composition, component tracking, and systemic resilience of the third-party ecosystem supporting the service.

SML 5.CO 1 TRANSPARENCY

Objective: To ensure dependencies on third-party providers are identified and transparent.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that customers have visibility into all third-party dependencies, enabling informed decisions and reducing hidden supply chain risks.

SML 5.CO 1.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Contracts with third-party providers disclose their involvement, roles, and responsibilities in delivering the service.

- **SML 5.CO 1.C 1.Q 1:** Does the contract disclose all third-party providers involved in delivering the service, including their roles and responsibilities?

SML 5.CO 1.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

An inventory of third-party dependencies, including subservice providers and external integrations, is maintained and documented.

- **SML 5.CO 1.C 2.Q 1:** Is there a maintained and documented inventory of all third-party dependencies, including subservice providers and external integrations?

SML 5.CO 1.C 3 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

The service provides customers with visibility into third-party dependencies that impact their service usage.

- **SML 5.CO 1.C 3.Q 1:** Are customers provided with visibility into third-party dependencies that impact their service usage?

SML 5.CO 2 SUPPLIER GOVERNANCE

Objective: To ensure that third-party providers are governed and controlled to prevent unmanaged dependency.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that third-party providers are subject to defined governance and control mechanisms, reducing dependency risks and preventing uncontrolled external influence on the service.

SML 5.CO 2.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Contracts with third-party providers define governance, roles, responsibilities, and control mechanisms for service delivery.

- **SML 5.CO 2.C 1.Q 1:** Does the contract define governance, responsibilities, and control mechanisms for third-party providers involved in service delivery?

SML 5.CO 2.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Governance processes are implemented and maintained to manage third-party providers, including oversight, performance monitoring, and risk management.

- **SML 5.CO 2.C 2.Q 1:** Are governance processes in place for managing third-party providers, including oversight, performance monitoring, and risk management?

SML 5.CO 2.C 3 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Third-party providers are integrated into service governance structures and subject to defined controls and oversight.

- **SML 5.CO 2.C 3.Q 1:** Are third-party providers integrated into service governance structures and subject to defined control and oversight mechanisms?

SML 5.CO 3 DEPENDENCY MANAGEMENT

Objective: To ensure that critical dependencies are identified and managed to reduce risk and dependency.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that critical dependencies are identified and actively managed, reducing concentration risk and preventing excessive reliance on individual third-party providers.

SML 5.CO 3.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Criteria are defined to identify and classify critical third-party dependencies based on their impact on service delivery, data, and operations.

- **SML 5.CO 3.C 1.Q 1:** Are criteria defined to identify and classify critical third-party dependencies based on their impact on service delivery, data, and operations?

SML 5.CO 3.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Documented assessments are performed and maintained to determine the criticality and associated risks of third-party dependencies.

- **SML 5.CO 3.C 2.Q 1:** Are documented assessments performed and maintained to determine the criticality and associated risks of third-party dependencies?

SML 5.CO 3.C 3 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Measures are implemented and maintained to manage and mitigate risks associated with critical third-party dependencies.

- **SML 5.CO 3.C 3.Q 1:** Are measures implemented and maintained to manage and mitigate risks associated with critical dependencies?

SML 5.CO 4 SUBSTITUTION AND EXIT

Objective: To ensure that dependencies are structured so that underlying providers can be substituted or relationships with them can be exited without excessive disruption.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that dependencies are structured to allow underlying providers to be replaced or relationships with them to be exited, reducing vendor lock-in and enabling continuity of service without excessive disruption.

SML 5.CO 4.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Exit strategies are defined and maintained for third-party dependencies, including procedures to replace or terminate providers.

- **SML 5.CO 4.C 1.Q 1:** Are exit strategies defined and maintained for third-party dependencies, including procedures for replacing or terminating providers?

SML 5.CO 4.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

The feasibility, impact, and effort involved in substituting providers or exiting relationships with them are assessed and documented for critical third-party dependencies.

- **SML 5.CO 4.C 2.Q 1:** Are the feasibility, impact, and effort required to substitute providers or exit relationships with them assessed and documented for critical third-party dependencies?

SML 5.CO 4.C 3 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Processes are in place for the substitution of providers or the exit of relationships with them without causing unacceptable disruption to service delivery in the context of third-party dependencies.

- **SML 5.CO 4.C 3.Q 1:** Can providers be substituted or relationships with them be exited without causing unacceptable disruption to service delivery in the context of third-party dependencies?

SML 5.CO 4.C 4 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: All

The service architecture is designed to minimize dependency on single third-party providers and supports substitution where feasible.

- **SML 5.CO 4.C 4.Q 1:** Is the service architecture designed to reduce dependency on single third-party providers and support substitution where feasible?

SML 5.CO 5 REQUIREMENT FLOW-DOWN

Objective: To ensure that digital sovereignty and control requirements are enforced across the supply chain.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that sovereignty and control requirements are consistently enforced across all third-party providers, preventing gaps and reducing risk from weak links in the supply chain.

SML 5.CO 5.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Contracts with third-party providers require compliance with defined digital sovereignty and control requirements.

- **SML 5.CO 5.C 1.Q 1:** Do contracts with third-party providers ensure that sovereignty and control requirements are imposed on them?

SML 5.CO 5.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Processes are implemented and maintained to verify that third-party providers comply with defined digital sovereignty and control requirements.

- **SML 5.CO 5.C 2.Q 1:** Are processes in place to verify that third-party providers comply with defined sovereignty and control requirements?

SML 5.CO 5.C 3 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Non-compliance by third-party providers is identified, managed, and remediated through defined processes.

- **SML 5.CO 5.C 3.Q 1:** Is non-compliance by third-party providers identified, managed, and remediated in a controlled manner?



SML 6 TECHNOLOGY SOVEREIGNTY

SML 6 — Technology Sovereignty

Technology sovereignty assesses the openness, auditability, and physical or logical layout of the underlying technical stack.

SML 6.CO 1 INFRASTRUCTURE LOCATION AND CONTROL

Objective: To ensure that the physical and virtual infrastructure is located and controlled within approved jurisdictions.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that the infrastructure underpinning the service is located and controlled within approved jurisdictions, preventing exposure to non-approved legal environments and reducing sovereignty risks.

SML 6.CO 1.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Contracts are in place to ensure that all infrastructure used to deliver the service is located within jurisdictions listed in the AJL.

- **SML 6.CO 1.C 1.Q 1:** Does the contract ensure that all infrastructure used to deliver the service is located within approved jurisdictions?

SML 6.CO 1.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Documented policies exist governing the selection and use of infrastructure locations, ensuring alignment with jurisdictions listed in the AJL.

- **SML 6.CO 1.C 2.Q 1:** Are policies in place governing the selection and use of infrastructure locations to ensure alignment with approved jurisdictions?

SML 6.CO 1.C 3 Technical

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: PaaS, IaaS

All infrastructure components, including primary, backup, failover, and replication environments, are located within jurisdictions listed in the AJL.

- **SML 6.CO 1.C 3.Q 1:** Are all infrastructure components, including primary, backup, failover, and replication environments, located within approved jurisdictions?

SML 6.CO 1.C 4 Technical

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: PaaS, IaaS

Transfers or processing of workloads to/via infrastructure not located within approved jurisdictions are prevented, including during failover or scaling scenarios.

- **SML 6.CO 1.C 4.Q 1:** Are mechanisms in place to prevent workloads from being transferred to or processed via infrastructure not located within approved jurisdictions, including during failover or scaling scenarios?

SML 6.CO 1.C 5 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

The service provides visibility into the locations of infrastructure used to deliver the service, including primary and secondary environments.

- **SML 6.CO 1.C 5.Q 1:** Are customers provided with visibility into the locations of infrastructure used to deliver the service, including primary and secondary environments?

SML 6.CO 2 USE OF OPEN STANDARDS

Objective: To ensure that open standards and interoperable technologies are used, where feasible.

Sovereignty Contribution: Enables customers to identify technological dependencies and assess sovereignty risks related to external platforms, third-party components, and jurisdictional exposure.

SML 6.CO 2.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Documented guidelines exist for using open standards and interoperable technologies in service design and implementation.

- **SML 6.CO 2.C 1.Q 1:** Are guidelines defined and maintained for the use of open standards and interoperable technologies in service design and implementation?

SML 6.CO 2.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

The use of proprietary versus open standards is assessed and documented, including justification for any proprietary technologies.

- **SML 6.CO 2.C 2.Q 1:** Is the use of proprietary versus open standards assessed and documented, including justification for any proprietary technologies used?

SML 6.CO 2.C 3 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

The service implements interfaces, data formats, and protocols based on open standards to enable interoperability where feasible.

- **SML 6.CO 2.C 3.Q 1:** Are service interfaces, data formats, and protocols implemented using open standards to ensure interoperability where feasible?

SML 6.CO 2.C 4 Technical

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: IaaS, PaaS

Underlying services use open and standardized technologies to enable interoperability and avoid enforced reliance on proprietary mechanisms.

- **SML 6.CO 2.C 4.Q 1:** Do the underlying services support the use of open and standardized technologies, enabling interoperability and avoiding enforced use of proprietary mechanisms?

SML 6.CO 2.C 5 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

The service avoids reliance on proprietary interfaces or formats that would limit interoperability or substitution.

- **SML 6.CO 2.C 5.Q 1:** Does the service use system architecture and technical specifications to avoid reliance on proprietary interfaces or formats where such reliance would limit interoperability or substitution?

SML 6.CO 3 PORTABILITY AND INTEROPERABILITY

Objective: To enable the service to be ported and integrated across different technical environments.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that the service can be migrated and integrated across different environments, reducing technical barriers and enabling flexibility and independence.

SML 6.CO 3.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Documented guidelines exist for designing services to enable portability and interoperability across different technical environments.

- **SML 6.CO 3.C 1.Q 1:** Are guidelines defined and maintained for designing services to ensure portability and interoperability across different technical environments?

SML 6.CO 3.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Portability assessments are conducted and documented, including the effort, constraints, and dependencies involved in migration to alternative environments.

- **SML 6.CO 3.C 2.Q 1:** Is the portability of the service assessed and documented, including the required effort, constraints, and dependencies involved in migration to alternative environments?

SML 6.CO 3.C 3 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

The service is designed and implemented using portable technologies and deployment models to enable deployment and operation across multiple environments.

- **SML 6.CO 3.C 3.Q 1:** Is the service designed and implemented to support deployment and operation across multiple environments using portable technologies and deployment models where feasible?

SML 6.CO 3.C 4 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

The service provides standardized and interoperable interfaces to enable integration with external systems.

- **SML 6.CO 3.C 4.Q 1:** Does the service support integration with external systems through standardized and interoperable interfaces?

SML 6.CO 3.C 5 Technical

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: PaaS, IaaS

Underlying services are configured to allow deployment, migration, and operation of workloads across different environments without enforcing platform-specific constraints.

- **SML 6.CO 3.C 5.Q 1:** Do the underlying services support deployment, migration, and operation of workloads across different environments without enforcing platform-specific constraints?

SML 6.CO 4 TECHNOLOGY CONTROL AND TRANSPARENCY

Objective: To ensure that the technology stack is transparent and under defined control.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that the technology stack is fully transparent and governed, enabling control over technical components and preventing hidden dependencies or opaque architectures.

SML 6.CO 4.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

The service provides customers with visibility into technology stack components that affect their service usage.

- **SML 6.CO 4.C 1.Q 1:** Is a complete and up-to-date inventory of the technology stack maintained, including platforms, components, and dependencies used to deliver the service?

SML 6.CO 4.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Governance processes exist for approving, managing, and controlling changes to the technology stack.

- **SML 6.CO 4.C 2.Q 1:** Are governance processes in place for approving, managing, and controlling changes to the technology stack?

SML 6.CO 4.C 3 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

All components used in the technology stack are disclosed, managed, and controlled to prevent hidden dependencies or risks.

- **SML 6.CO 4.C 3.Q 1:** Are mechanisms in place to ensure that no undisclosed or unmanaged components are used within the technology stack?



SML 7 SECURITY AND COMPLIANCE SOVEREIGNTY

SML 7 — Security and Compliance Sovereignty

Security and compliance sovereignty evaluates the isolation, administrative control, and auditability of security configurations and compliance mechanisms.

SML 7.CO 1 IDENTITY AND ACCESS

Objective: To ensure that access to the service is protected and controlled to prevent unauthorized use.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that access to the service is securely controlled and not solely dependent on the provider, enabling customers to retain control over identities and access permissions.

SML 7.CO 1.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Policies for identity and access, including authentication, authorization, and access control, are formally defined and documented.

- **SML 7.CO 1.C 1.Q 1:** Are policies defined and maintained for identity and access management, including authentication, authorization, and access control principles?

SML 7.CO 1.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Privileged access is restricted, documented, monitored, and managed according to defined controls.

- **SML 7.CO 1.C 2.Q 1:** Is access to privileged accounts limited, documented, and regularly monitored for compliance with defined controls?

SML 7.CO 1.C 3 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

Strong authentication mechanisms, including multi-factor authentication for privileged or sensitive access, are enforced for all user accounts.

- **SML 7.CO 1.C 3.Q 1:** Are strong authentication mechanisms enforced in accordance with defined policies, including multi-factor authentication for privileged or sensitive access?

SML 7.CO 1.C 4 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

Access is controlled using role-based or attribute-based mechanisms, ensuring users only have access according to their defined roles and responsibilities.

- **SML 7.CO 1.C 4.Q 1:** Is there a formal concept or policy for role-based or attribute-based access controls that ensures users have access only according to their defined roles and responsibilities?

SML 7.CO 1.C 5 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

Segregation of access between the customer and provider is enforced, preventing unauthorized or undisclosed privileged access by the provider.

- **SML 7.CO 1.C 5.Q 1:** How is access between the customer and provider controlled to prevent unrestricted or undisclosed privileged access by the provider?

SML 7.CO 1.C 6 Technical

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: PaaS, IaaS

Identity and access control mechanisms, including identity federation and integration with external identity providers, are supported and enforced for all users.

- **SML 7.CO 1.C 6.Q 1:** How are identity and access control mechanisms implemented in the underlying services, including identity federation and integration with external identity providers?

SML 7.CO 2 SECURITY VISIBILITY AND CONTROL

Objective: To ensure that customers have visibility into and control over security mechanisms relevant to their service.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that customers are not dependent on the provider's internal security operations by providing visibility and control over relevant security mechanisms.

SML 7.CO 2.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Documented policies are in place for providing customers with visibility into and control over security mechanisms, and mechanisms are in place to enforce the implementation of these policies.

- **SML 7.CO 2.C 1.Q 1:** Are policies defined and maintained to provide customers with visibility into and control over security mechanisms?

SML 7.CO 2.C 2 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

Customers are provided with role-based access to view security configurations and settings relevant to their service usage.

- **SML 7.CO 2.C 2.Q 1:** Are mechanisms in place to provide customers with role-based access to view security configurations and mechanisms relevant to their service usage?

SML 7.CO 2.C 3 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

Authorized customer users can configure and manage security settings within their scope of responsibility through defined interfaces.

- **SML 7.CO 2.C 3.Q 1:** Are mechanisms in place that enable authorized customer users to configure and manage security settings within their defined scope of responsibility through defined interfaces?

SML 7.CO 2.C 4 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

Customers have visibility into security-relevant configurations and their impact on the service, including logging of configuration changes.

- **SML 7.CO 2.C 4.Q 1:** Are mechanisms in place to provide customers with visibility into security-relevant configurations and their impact on the service, including logging of configuration changes?

SML 7.CO 2.C 5 Technical

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: PaaS, IaaS

Underlying services allow configuration and management of security controls, ensuring that configurations are valid and secure.

- **SML 7.CO 2.C 5.Q 1:** Do the underlying services provide mechanisms to configure and manage security controls relevant to the service, ensuring configurations are valid and secure?

SML 7.CO 3 SENSITIVE OPERATIONS

Objective: To ensure that sensitive operations are protected against misuse or unauthorized execution.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that critical operations cannot be executed without appropriate protection, reducing the risk of misuse and strengthening customer control over high-impact actions.

SML 7.CO 3.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Documented policies are in place for protecting sensitive operations against misuse or unauthorized execution, and mechanisms are in place to enforce these policies.

- **SML 7.CO 3.C 1.Q 1:** Are policies defined and maintained to protect sensitive operations against misuse or unauthorized execution?

SML 7.CO 3.C 2 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

Additional safeguards for sensitive operations, such as multistep approval, strong authentication, or confirmation mechanisms, are implemented and enforced.

- **SML 7.CO 3.C 2.Q 1:** Are additional safeguards enforced for sensitive operations, such as multistep approval, strong authentication, or confirmation mechanisms?

SML 7.CO 3.C 3 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

Execution of sensitive operations is restricted to authorized roles with clearly defined permissions.

- **SML 7.CO 3.C 3.Q 1:** Are sensitive operations restricted to authorized roles with clearly defined permissions?

SML 7.CO 3.C 4 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: Managed Service, AI Service, SaaS

Mechanisms are in place to log and ensure traceability of sensitive operations.

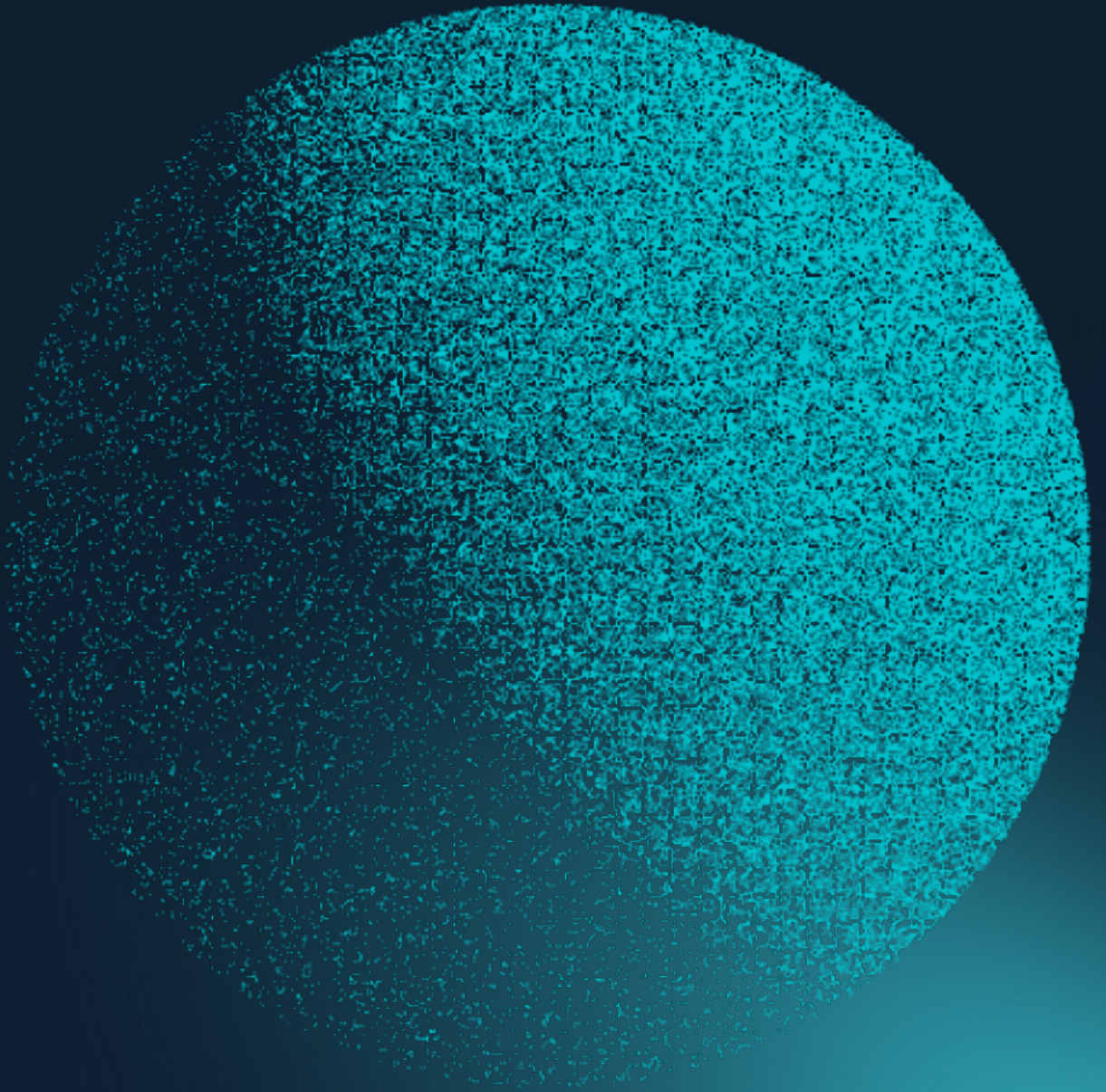
- **SML 7.CO 3.C 4.Q 1:** Are sensitive operations traceable and logged?

SML 7.CO 3.C 5 Technical

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: PaaS, IaaS

Underlying services protect and control the execution of sensitive operations, enforcing defined security requirements.

- **SML 7.CO 3.C 5.Q 1:** Do the underlying services support mechanisms to protect and control the execution of sensitive operations, including enforcement of defined security requirements?



SML 8 ENVIRONMENTAL SUSTAINABILITY

SML 8 — Environmental Sustainability

Environmental sustainability evaluates the long-term operational resilience, resource dependency profiles, and metric transparency of the service with regard to environmental constraints.

SML 8.CO 1 ENERGY AUTONOMY

Objective: To ensure that the service is operated with controlled and resilient energy dependencies that do not introduce critical risks to long-term operation.

Sovereignty Contribution: Reduces reliance on unstable or externally controlled energy sources, ensuring continuous and sovereign service operation.

SML 8.CO 1.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: All

Underlying service providers have contractually defined and governed energy supply arrangements and dependencies.

- **SML 8.CO 1.C 1.Q 1:** Do underlying service providers have contractually defined and governed energy supply arrangements and dependencies?

SML 8.CO 1.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

The service provider has defined policies and processes to identify, assess, and monitor energy-supply dependencies relevant to the service.

- **SML 8.CO 1.C 2.Q 1:** Has the service provider defined policies and processes to identify, assess, and monitor energy-supply dependencies?

SML 8.CO 2 RESOURCE DEPENDENCIES

Objective: To ensure that dependencies on critical resources (e.g., hardware, cooling, materials) are identified, controlled, and do not create structural risks.

Sovereignty Contribution: Limits exposure to resource scarcity and external supply dependencies that could affect service continuity and sovereignty.

SML 8.CO 2.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: All

Underlying service providers have contractually defined and governed dependencies on critical resources required for service operation.

- **SML 8.CO 2.C 1.Q 1:** Do underlying service providers have contractually defined and governed dependencies on critical resources required for service operation?

SML 8.CO 2.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

The service provider has defined policies and processes to identify, assess, and monitor dependencies on critical resources relevant to the service.

- **SML 8.CO 2.C 2.Q 1:** Does the service provider have defined policies and processes to identify, assess, and monitor dependencies on critical resources?

SML 8.CO 3 ENVIRONMENTAL RISK EXPOSURE

Objective: To ensure that environmental risk exposure affecting service operation is understood and considered in the design and operation of the service.

Sovereignty Contribution: Reduces structural risks from environmental conditions that could impact long-term control and operability.

SML 8.CO 3.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: All

Underlying service providers identify and assess environmental risk exposure relevant to service operation.

- **SML 8.CO 3.C 1.Q 1:** Do underlying service providers identify and assess environmental risk exposure relevant to service operation?

SML 8.CO 3.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

The service provider assesses and considers environmental risk exposure when designing or operating the service.

- **SML 8.CO 3.C 2.Q 1:** Does the service provider assess and consider environmental risk exposure of underlying services when designing or operating the service?

SML 8.CO 4 DEPENDENCY TRANSPARENCY

Objective: To ensure transparency regarding energy usage, resource dependencies, and environmental constraints relevant to the service.
Sovereignty Contribution: Enables customers to understand and manage environmental dependencies impacting sovereignty.

SML 8.CO 4.C 1 Contractual

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: All

Underlying service providers provide transparency regarding environmental dependencies and constraints relevant to service operation.

- **SML 8.CO 4.C 1.Q 1:** Do underlying service providers provide transparency regarding environmental dependencies and constraints relevant to service operation?

SML 8.CO 4.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

The service provider ensures that relevant environmental dependencies of underlying services are known and documented.

- **SML 8.CO 4.C 2.Q 1:** Does the service provider ensure that relevant environmental dependencies of underlying services are known and documented?

SML 8.CO 5 LONG-TERM OPERATIONAL SUSTAINABILITY

Objective: To ensure that the service is designed and operated such that it remains stable and operable over time despite environmental and resource constraints.

Sovereignty Contribution: Supports sustained sovereignty by ensuring the long-term availability and independence of the service.

SML 8.CO 5.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: All

Underlying service providers consider long-term environmental and resource-related constraints in their operational planning.

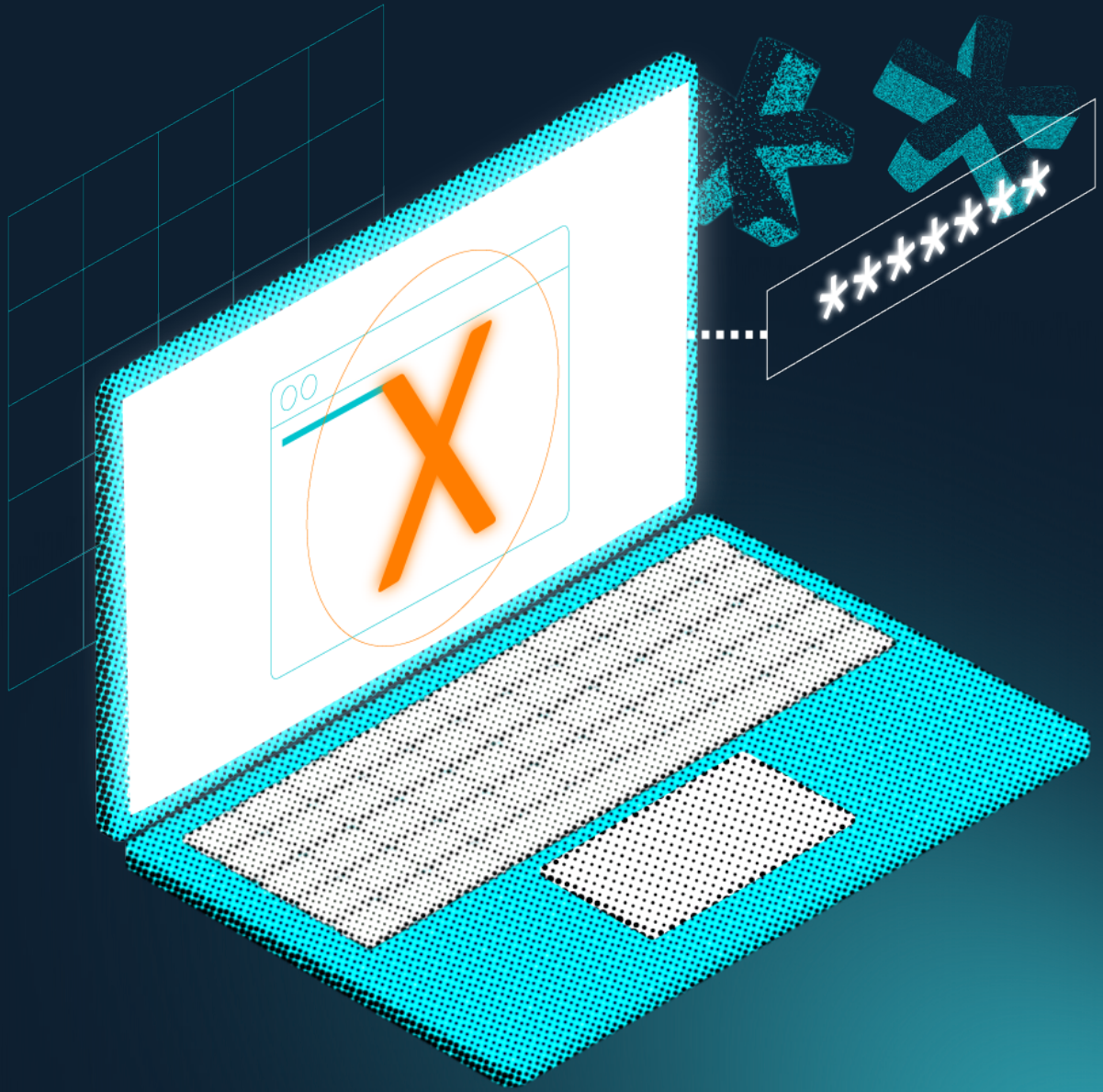
- **SML 8.CO 5.C 1.Q 1:** Do underlying service providers consider long-term environmental and resource-related constraints in their operational planning?

SML 8.CO 5.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Underlying Service | Service Type: All

The service provider considers long-term environmental and resource-related constraints when selecting and using underlying services.

- **SML 8.CO 5.C 2.Q 1:** Does the service provider consider long-term environmental and resource-related constraints when selecting and using underlying services?



SML 9

AI SOVEREIGNTY

SML 9 — AI Sovereignty

AI sovereignty evaluates the organizational oversight, system clarity, and independent control of artificial intelligence solutions.

SML 9.CO 1 AI GOVERNANCE

Objective: To ensure that governance structures are established to define responsibility, oversight, and accountability for the development, deployment, and operation of AI systems.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that AI systems are subject to organizational oversight and are not operated without clear responsibility or control.

SML 9.CO 1.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

The service provider has defined and documented governance structures for the development, deployment, and operation of AI systems.

- **SML 9.CO 1.C 1.Q 1:** Has the service provider defined and documented governance structures for the development, deployment, and operation of AI systems?

SML 9.CO 1.C 2 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: All

The service ensures that AI-driven decisions can be controlled, restricted, or overridden where necessary.

- **SML 9.CO 1.C 2.Q 1:** Does the service ensure that AI-driven decisions can be controlled, restricted, or overridden where necessary?

SML 9.CO 1.C 3 Governance and Operations

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: All

The use of AI within the service can be configured or limited by the customer or operator.

- **SML 9.CO 1.C 3.Q 1:** Can the use of AI within the service be configured or limited by the customer or operator?

SML 9.CO 2 AI TRANSPARENCY

Objective: To achieve a situation whereby the provider ensures that the architecture, capabilities, limitations, and intended use of AI models are documented and communicated to relevant stakeholders.

Sovereignty Contribution: Enables customers and regulators to understand how AI systems operate and prevents opaque "black box" dependencies.

SML 9.CO 2.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: All

The architecture, key components, capabilities, limitations, and intended use of AI models are defined and documented.

- **SML 9.CO 2.C 1.Q 1:** Are the architecture, key components, capabilities, limitations, and intended use of AI models defined and documented?

SML 9.CO 2.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: All

AI documentation is made available to relevant stakeholders and customers in accordance with governance policies and legal requirements.

- **SML 9.CO 2.C 2.Q 1:** Is documentation about AI systems available to relevant stakeholders?

SML 9.CO 3 EXPLAINABILITY

Objective: To ensure that AI systems are designed in a way that allows meaningful explanation of decision-making processes and enables human oversight or intervention where necessary.

Sovereignty Contribution: Ensures that organizations remain in control of automated decision-making processes rather than delegating authority entirely to AI systems.

SML 9.CO 3.C 1 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: AI Service

The service provides mechanisms to review AI-generated outputs or decisions before or after execution, where relevant.

- **SML 9.CO 3.C 1.Q 1:** Does the service provide mechanisms to review AI-generated outputs or decisions, where relevant?

SML 9.CO 3.C 2 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: AI Service

AI systems are designed to incorporate explainability mechanisms tailored to the underlying model type, including providing appropriate metrics.

SML 9.CO 3.C 3 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: AI Service

Human oversight mechanisms are defined for critical AI-driven decisions.

SML 9.CO 3.C 4 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: AI Service

Policies and procedures define when and how human oversight is required for AI-driven decisions.

- **SML 9.CO 3.C 2.Q 1:** Are AI systems designed to incorporate explainability mechanisms tailored to the underlying model type, including providing appropriate metrics and documentation?

- **SML 9.CO 3.C 3.Q 1:** Are human oversight mechanisms defined for critical AI-driven decisions?

- **SML 9.CO 3.C 4.Q 1:** Are policies and procedures defined specifying when and how human oversight is required for AI-driven decisions?

SML 9.CO 4 EXTERNAL AI DEPENDENCIES

Objective: To ensure that dependencies on external AI services are transparent, controlled, and do not lead to loss of control over AI functionality.

Sovereignty Contribution: Prevents lock-in and loss of control by ensuring that reliance on external AI providers does not undermine autonomy or operational independence.

SML 9.CO 4.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

The service clearly identifies and documents dependencies on external AI services used within its functionality.

SML 9.CO 4.C 2 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: All

The service is designed to control or limit the use of external AI services where necessary.

SML 9.CO 4.C 3 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Alternative solutions or fallback options are defined for critical dependencies on external AI services.

- **SML 9.CO 4.C 1.Q 1:** Are dependencies on external AI services used within the service identified and documented?

- **SML 9.CO 4.C 2.Q 1:** Is the service designed to control or limit the use of external AI services where necessary?

- **SML 9.CO 4.C 3.Q 1:** Are alternative solutions or fallback options defined for critical dependencies on external AI services?

SML 9.CO 5 AI LIFE CYCLE MANAGEMENT

Objective: To achieve a situation whereby the organization manages the life cycle of AI models, including training, validation, deployment, monitoring, retraining, and retirement.

Sovereignty Contribution: Prevents uncontrolled model drift and ensures long-term accountability for AI behavior.

SML 9.CO 5.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: AI Service

The life cycle of AI models is documented, including training, validation, deployment, monitoring, retirement, and complete model lineage information.

SML 9.CO 5.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: AI Service

AI models and changes are validated before deployment. Validation data is documented and updated regularly.

SML 9.CO 5.C 3 Governance and Operations

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: AI Service

AI model performance is regularly monitored after deployment.

- **SML 9.CO 5.C 1.Q 1:** Is the life cycle of AI models documented and regularly reviewed?

- **SML 9.CO 5.C 2.Q 1:** Are AI models validated before deployment and are validation procedures and results documented?

- **SML 9.CO 5.C 3.Q 1:** Are monitoring metrics defined and AI model performance monitored after deployment?

SML 9.CO 5.C 4 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: AI Service
Processes exist for retraining or updating models when necessary.

- **SML 9.CO 5.C 4.Q 1:** Are processes defined for retraining or updating AI models?

SML 9.CO 6 CONTROL OVER AI ASSETS

Objective: To ensure that AI model artifacts, including weights and architecture, remain under the control of the service provider and are protected from unauthorized access or modification by the infrastructure provider.

Sovereignty Contribution: Preserves AI sovereignty by preventing infrastructure providers from accessing or modifying model artifacts during execution.

SML 9.CO 6.C 1 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: AI Service
The service ensures that AI model artifacts (e.g., model weights, configurations) remain under the control of the service provider.

- **SML 9.CO 6.C 1.Q 1:** Are AI model artifacts, including model weights, configurations, and architecture, documented and controlled by the service provider and protected from unauthorized access?

SML 9.CO 6.C 2 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: AI Service
Access to AI model artifacts is restricted and controlled to prevent unauthorized access or modification.

- **SML 9.CO 6.C 2.Q 1:** Is access to AI model artifacts restricted and controlled, including the documentation and enforcement of access permissions?

SML 9.CO 6.C 3 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: AI Service
The service provider defines policies and processes to maintain control over AI model artifacts.

- **SML 9.CO 6.C 3.Q 1:** Are policies and processes defined and implemented to maintain control over AI model artifacts?

SML 9.CO 7 EXTERNAL ACCESS TO TRAINING DATA

Objective: To ensure that dependencies on external AI providers do not allow access to training data, which must remain confidential and protected from disclosure, storage, or reuse by the external provider.

Sovereignty Contribution: Preserves AI data sovereignty by preventing external AI providers from accessing or retaining training data during processing.

SML 9.CO 7.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All
Safeguards are defined and implemented to prevent disclosure or retention of training data.

- **SML 9.CO 7.C 1.Q 1:** Are safeguards defined and implemented to prevent disclosure or retention of training data?

SML 9.CO 7.C 2 Contractual

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All
Contracts with external AI providers define restrictions on the use of customer data as training data.

- **SML 9.CO 7.C 2.Q 1:** Do contracts with external AI providers restrict the use of customer data as training data?

SML 9.CO 7.C 3 Technical

Scope: Client-Facing Service | Service Type: All
Technical mechanisms prevent external AI providers from storing or reusing training data.

- **SML 9.CO 7.C 3.Q 1:** Are technical mechanisms implemented to prevent storage or reuse of training data by external providers?

SML 9.CO 8 TRAINING DATA

Objective: To achieve a situation whereby organizations maintain transparency and governance over the sources, ownership, and legal status of training data used for AI models.

Sovereignty Contribution: Prevents hidden legal, ethical, or jurisdictional risks related to training datasets.

SML 9.CO 8.C 1 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Sources of training data used for AI models are documented, versioned, and periodically reviewed.

- **SML 9.CO 8.C 1.Q 1:** Are sources of AI training data documented, versioned, and periodically reviewed?

SML 9.CO 8.C 2 Governance and Operations

Scope: Service Provider | Service Type: All

Ownership and legal rights associated with training data for AI models are assessed and documented.

- **SML 9.CO 8.C 2.Q 1:** Are ownership and legal rights associated with training data for AI models assessed and documented?

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